

Document 25. Connector & Signposting Phrasebank

Categorised phrase lists for high-band essays and CSQ answers. Use these to signpost structure, advance argument, and pivot between sides.

Section A. Opening an Essay or CSQ Part

- This essay examines...
- The question raises the issue of...
- In order to address this question, we must first define...
- This response considers two sides of the debate before reaching a reasoned conclusion.
- The framework of *X* provides a useful starting point.

Section B. Defining a Term

- *Term* refers to...
- Formally, *Term* is defined as...
- In economics, *Term* is understood as...
- For the purposes of this question, *Term* denotes...

Section C. Introducing a Diagram

- This effect can be illustrated using the *X* diagram below.
- Consider Figure 1, which shows...
- The diagram shows initial equilibrium at E_0 where...
- Following the shock, the curve shifts *rightward* / *leftward* / *upward*, as shown...

Section D. Cause-and-Effect Chain

- Consequently... / Therefore... / It follows that...
- As a result, *X* causes *Y* via...
- This in turn triggers...
- Through the transmission mechanism of...
- Holding other things equal (*ceteris paribus*)...

Section E. Adding Detail or Magnitude

- More specifically...
- In particular...

- The size of the effect depends on. . .
- Empirically. . . / Recent data shows. . .
- According to the source (Extract X, line Y) . . .

Section F. Anchoring in Singapore Context

- In the Singaporean context. . .
- Given Singapore's openness and high import content. . .
- Drawing on the MAS framework. . .
- The Ministry of Trade and Industry has noted that. . .
- For an SOE like Singapore, this implies. . .

Section G. Two-Sided Discussion

- On the one hand. . . / On the other hand. . .
- Proponents of X argue that. . .
- Critics counter that. . .
- However, this view must be qualified by. . .
- A more compelling counter-argument is. . .
- While X is true, it is not the dominant consideration because. . .

Section H. Evaluation Signals

- Ultimately. . . / Overall. . . / On balance. . .
- The decisive factor is. . .
- Provided that X , the conclusion holds.
- In the short run. . . , but in the long run. . .
- Subject to the assumption that. . .
- The magnitude of the effect is contingent on. . .

Section I. Concluding a Question

- In conclusion. . .
- To sum up. . .
- The analysis suggests that. . .
- Hence, the most appropriate policy mix is. . .
- Therefore, the answer to the question is. . . (state your stance) because. . . (key reason).
- This conclusion holds in the present context, although the balance could shift if. . .

Section J. Comparing and Contrasting

- Compared to X , Y is...
- Both X and Y share the property that..., but differ in...
- Unlike X , Y ...
- Whereas X leads to..., Y leads to...

Section K. Cautioning the Reader

- It must be noted that...
- This is subject to the caveat that...
- One should not over-state the case...
- The data, however, does not capture...
- The conclusion may differ in a different economic context.